

IN THE SENATE

SENATE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 126

BY STATE AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

A CONCURRENT RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE LEGISLATURE, DECLARING THAT THE COMMUNITY SCHOOL STRATEGY IS A PROVEN, LOCALLY DRIVEN APPROACH TO STUDENT SUCCESS AND STRONGER COMMUNITIES, AND ENCOURAGING CONTINUED COLLABORATION AMONG SCHOOLS, FAMILIES, AND COMMUNITY PARTNERS TO EXPAND AND SUSTAIN COMMUNITY SCHOOL EFFORTS THROUGHOUT THE STATE IN WAYS THAT REFLECT THE VALUES OF THE STATE AND LOCAL LEADERSHIP.

Be It Resolved by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, the Idaho Coalition for Community Schools is a cross-sector network of educators, nonprofits, and community leaders committed to strengthening and expanding community schools in Idaho, with United Way of Treasure Valley providing backbone support and coordination; and

WHEREAS, the community school strategy transforms schools into neighborhood hubs, partnering with families and community members to provide integrated health and social services and enhanced learning opportunities. It reduces barriers to learning through four key pillars: integrated student supports, expanded learning, family engagement, and collaborative leadership; and

WHEREAS, Idaho's strength and long-term prosperity depend on the success of its children and the vitality of its families and communities; and

WHEREAS, when students are healthy, supported, and engaged, they are better prepared to learn, graduate, and contribute to Idaho's workforce and civic life; and

WHEREAS, schools serve as trusted centers of community life and are uniquely positioned to partner with families, nonprofits, businesses, faith communities, and local organizations to help remove barriers to learning; and

WHEREAS, the community school strategy is a voluntary, locally driven approach that empowers schools to design partnerships that reflect the unique needs and values of their communities; and

WHEREAS, for more than ten years, Idaho educators, families, and community partners have advanced this work across the state; and

WHEREAS, today, 65 schools across 25 districts, representing every Idaho education region, are engaged in community school efforts.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the Senate and the House of Representatives concurring therein, that the Legislature recognizes the community school strategy as a proven, community-based framework for strengthening student success and supporting families across Idaho.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature encourages continued collaboration among schools, families, and community partners to expand and sustain community school efforts throughout the state in ways that reflect the values of the state and local leadership.